



SOALAN TUGASAN/ASSIGNMENT QUESTION

MAY 2026 SEMESTER

SUBJECT CODE	: UCS102
SUBJECT TITLE	: ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN ASIA
LEVEL	: BACHELOR

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INSTRUCTIONS TO STUDENTS

- 1) This assignment consists of **THREE (3)** part. Answer **ALL** questions.
- 2) Plagiarism in all forms is forbidden. Students who submit plagiarised assignment will be penalised.
- 3) Continuous assessment (assignment) carries **70%** of the final grade.
- 4) References **MUST** be included and taken from reliable sources. Please use the APA Referencing Style and cite your work appropriately.
- 5) The submission of this assignment must be made **BEFORE OR ON 20 JULY 2026 via AeU MyPLS.**

THERE ARE SEVEN [7] PAGES OF QUESTIONS, EXCLUDING THIS PAGE.

DECLARATION BY STUDENT

I certify that this assignment is my own work and is in my own words. All sources have been acknowledged and the content has not been previously submitted for assessment to Asia e University or elsewhere. I also confirm that I have kept a copy of this assignment.

Signed: __Khanza Haura__

ANSWERS:

SECTION A

Factors Contributing to the Success of Malaysian Entrepreneurs

Entrepreneurship has become an important driver of Malaysia's economic development, contributing significantly to employment creation, innovation, and national competitiveness. As the country continues to embrace digital transformation and economic diversification, entrepreneurship has gained greater attention from both the public and private sectors. Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) form the backbone of Malaysia's business landscape and play a major role in supporting economic resilience. The government's continuous efforts to encourage entrepreneurship have also created more opportunities for individuals to establish and expand their businesses.

The entrepreneurial environment in Malaysia has improved considerably over the past decade. Digital technologies, e-commerce platforms, and government support programs have lowered the barriers to starting a business. Agencies such as SME Corporation Malaysia, MARA, and TEKUN Nasional provide financial assistance, entrepreneurship training, business mentoring, and advisory services. These initiatives enable aspiring entrepreneurs to develop practical business knowledge while improving access to funding and market opportunities. At the same time, Malaysia's multicultural society creates diverse consumer markets, allowing entrepreneurs to introduce products and services that cater to different cultural preferences.

Although external support is important, the personal qualities of entrepreneurs remain one of the strongest determinants of business success. Successful entrepreneurs are typically confident decision-makers who remain committed even when facing uncertainty. They demonstrate resilience by learning from failures instead of giving up after setbacks. Creativity and innovation also help entrepreneurs respond to changing customer expectations and identify new market opportunities. Furthermore, successful business owners continuously improve their knowledge and remain adaptable in an increasingly competitive environment.

Besides management skills, entrepreneurs benefit from strong support systems. Family members often provide emotional encouragement, financial assistance, and valuable advice, particularly during the early stages of a business. Society contributes by supporting local businesses and promoting entrepreneurial culture.

Government agencies and private financial institutions further strengthen the entrepreneurial ecosystem through grants, financing schemes, training programmes, and networking opportunities.

However, entrepreneurial success is never guaranteed. Poor financial planning, ineffective leadership, inadequate market research, and an inability to adapt to technological changes often contribute to business failure. Entrepreneurs who ignore customer needs or fail to innovate may struggle to remain competitive in rapidly changing markets.

Several Malaysian entrepreneurs illustrate these success factors. Tony Fernandes successfully transformed AirAsia into one of Asia's most recognised low-cost airlines by combining visionary leadership with operational efficiency and customer-focused innovation. Similarly, Vivy Yusof expanded FashionValet from a small online fashion platform into a well-known regional brand by embracing digital entrepreneurship and supporting local designers. Their achievements demonstrate that entrepreneurial success depends not only on personal determination but also on effective management, continuous innovation, and strong institutional support.

In conclusion, the success of Malaysian entrepreneurs is shaped by a combination of favourable business conditions, entrepreneurial characteristics, sound management practices, and support from families, government agencies, and society. These interconnected factors continue to strengthen Malaysia's entrepreneurial ecosystem while contributing to sustainable economic growth.

References

1. Department of Statistics Malaysia. (2024). *Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) Performance Report 2023*.
2. SME Corporation Malaysia. (2024). *SME Annual Report 2023/2024*.
3. Ministry of Entrepreneur and Cooperatives Development (KUSKOP). (2023). *Entrepreneurship Development Policies and Programmes*.
4. Hisrich, R. D., Peters, M. P., & Shepherd, D. A. (2020). *Entrepreneurship* (11th ed.). McGraw-Hill.
5. Kuratko, D. F. (2021). *Entrepreneurship: Theory, Process, Practice* (11th ed.). Cengage Learning.
6. Schaper, M., Volery, T., Weber, P., & Lewis, K. (2020). *Entrepreneurship and Small Business* (6th ed.). Wiley.

SECTION B

Women Entrepreneurs in Malaysia

1. Analyse and describe the current situation of women entrepreneurs in Malaysia.

Women entrepreneurs have become an increasingly important part of Malaysia's entrepreneurial ecosystem. Over the past decade, the number of women-owned businesses has grown steadily due to improvements in education, digital technology, and government support. Many women are now running businesses in sectors such as food and beverages, fashion, beauty, healthcare, education, tourism, and online retail. The rapid expansion of e-commerce platforms and social media has also made it easier for women to promote products, reach customers, and manage businesses with relatively low start-up costs.

The Malaysian government recognises the economic contribution of women entrepreneurs and has introduced various initiatives to encourage their participation in business. Agencies such as SME Corporation Malaysia, MARA, Amanah Ikhtiar Malaysia (AIM), and TEKUN Nasional provide financial assistance, entrepreneurship training, mentoring programmes, and advisory services. These initiatives help women improve their business knowledge while increasing access to funding and market opportunities.

In addition, digital transformation has created new possibilities for women entrepreneurs. Online marketplaces, digital payment systems, and social media marketing enable businesses to operate beyond geographical boundaries. Many women now manage successful home-based enterprises while maintaining flexibility in balancing work and family responsibilities. This has encouraged greater female participation in entrepreneurship compared to previous generations.

Several Malaysian women have become well-known business leaders. One notable example is **Vivy Yusof**, co-founder of FashionValet, who successfully built one of Malaysia's leading online fashion platforms while promoting local designers across Southeast Asia. Another successful entrepreneur is **Datuk Seri Dr. Hasmiza Othman**, widely known as **Datuk Seri Vida**, who transformed her cosmetics and health products into nationally recognised brands through innovative marketing and strong personal branding. Their achievements demonstrate that women can build competitive businesses despite operating in highly competitive industries.

Overall, women entrepreneurs continue to make significant contributions to Malaysia's economy by creating employment opportunities, encouraging innovation, and strengthening the country's SME sector. Although challenges remain, their participation in entrepreneurship continues to increase with support from both public and private institutions.

2. Identify and discuss the success factors and challenges faced by women entrepreneurs.

The success of women entrepreneurs in Malaysia is influenced by a combination of personal qualities, business capabilities, and external support. One of the most important success factors is determination. Successful entrepreneurs remain committed to achieving their business goals despite facing uncertainty and competition. Confidence, perseverance, and a positive attitude allow them to overcome obstacles while continuously improving their businesses.

Innovation is another essential factor. Women entrepreneurs who regularly introduce new products, improve service quality, and adapt to changing customer preferences are more likely to maintain their competitive advantage. In today's digital economy, technological skills have become increasingly valuable. The effective use of e-commerce platforms, social media marketing, and digital payment systems enables entrepreneurs to expand their customer base and increase sales.

Business management skills also contribute significantly to entrepreneurial success. Financial planning, budgeting, inventory management, and strategic marketing help businesses remain profitable and sustainable. Networking is equally important because professional relationships with customers, suppliers, mentors, and industry associations provide valuable knowledge, collaboration opportunities, and access to new markets. Government support through entrepreneurship programmes, grants, and training further strengthens women's ability to establish and expand their businesses.

Despite these advantages, women entrepreneurs continue to encounter several challenges. One common difficulty is obtaining sufficient financing, especially during the early stages of business development. Many small businesses experience limited access to loans or investment due to insufficient collateral or limited business records. Another major challenge is balancing business responsibilities with family commitments. Many women must simultaneously manage childcare, household responsibilities, and business operations, which can increase physical and emotional pressure.

Market competition also presents significant challenges. The rapid growth of online businesses means entrepreneurs must continuously innovate to remain competitive. At the same time, economic uncertainty, inflation, and changing consumer behaviour require businesses to respond quickly to market changes. In addition, the fast pace of digital transformation requires continuous learning, as entrepreneurs need to update their technological knowledge to remain competitive.

In conclusion, women entrepreneurs have become an essential force in Malaysia's economic development. Their success is driven by resilience, innovation, effective management, and strong institutional support. Although they continue to face challenges related to financing, work-life balance, and market competition, ongoing government initiatives and technological advancement provide greater opportunities for women to achieve long-term entrepreneurial success.

References:

- Department of Statistics Malaysia. (2024). Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) Performance Report 2023.
- SME Corporation Malaysia. (2024). SME Annual Report 2023/2024.
- Ministry of Entrepreneur and Cooperatives Development (KUSKOP). (2023). Entrepreneurship Development Policies and Programmes.
- Amanah Ikhtiar Malaysia. (2024). Annual Report.
- Hisrich, R. D., Peters, M. P., & Shepherd, D. A. (2020). Entrepreneurship (11th ed.). McGraw-Hill.
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SECTION C

1. Financial planning is the long-term process of wisely managing one's finances in order to achieve personal goals and dreams, while simultaneously navigating financial barriers that inevitably arise at every stage of life. It involves setting clear financial objectives, assessing current financial resources, and creating a structured plan to allocate income, savings, and investments effectively. Financial planning is based on answering three key questions: "Where am I now?", "Where do I want to go?", and "How do I get from here to there?".

2. Benefits of Financial Planning (6 Marks)

Financial planning offers numerous benefits that help individuals secure their financial future and improve their quality of life:

- **Goal Achievement:** A well-structured financial plan helps individuals set and achieve specific, measurable, achievable, realistic, and time-framed (SMART) goals, such as buying a house, funding education, or retiring comfortably.
- **Better Financial Control:** Financial planning enables individuals to keep their finances under control by tracking income, expenses, assets, and liabilities. This helps prevent overspending and ensures that money is allocated wisely.
- **Risk Management:** Through insurance planning and emergency fund creation, financial planning helps individuals prepare for unexpected events such as job loss, illness, or accidents, thereby reducing financial stress.
- **Improved Decision-Making:** A financial plan provides a clear roadmap, allowing individuals to make informed decisions about spending, saving, investing, and borrowing. This reduces impulsive financial choices and promotes long-term stability.
- **Wealth Accumulation:** By prioritising savings and investments, financial planning helps individuals build wealth over time through compound interest, diversified portfolios, and strategic asset allocation.
- **Retirement Security:** Financial planning ensures that individuals prepare adequately for retirement by estimating future needs, contributing to retirement accounts, and creating sustainable income streams for their post-working years.

3. Net worth is a key indicator of financial health, calculated as the difference between what you own (assets) and what you owe (liabilities). The five steps to derive your net worth are as follows:

1. **List All Assets:** Identify and record everything you own that has monetary value. This includes cash, savings accounts, investments (stocks, bonds, mutual funds), real estate, vehicles, jewellery, and other valuable possessions.
2. **Determine the Value of Each Asset:** Assign a current market value to each asset. For example, use the latest bank statement for savings, the current market price for stocks, and the estimated resale value for vehicles and property.
3. **List All Liabilities:** Identify and record all your debts and financial obligations. This includes mortgages, car loans, student loans, credit card balances, personal loans, and any other outstanding bills.
4. **Determine the Amount Owed for Each Liability:** Record the current outstanding balance for each liability. For loans, use the remaining principal; for credit cards, use the current balance due.

4. If you find yourself in financial trouble, there are several practical steps you can take to regain control:

- **Create a Budget:** Track your income and expenses to understand where your money is going. Use budgeting tools or apps to categorise spending and identify areas where you can cut back. A realistic budget helps you prioritise essential expenses and avoid unnecessary debt.
- **Build an Emergency Fund:** Start saving a small amount regularly to create a buffer for unexpected expenses. Even a modest emergency fund can prevent you from relying on credit cards or loans during crises.
- **Reduce and Manage Debt:** Prioritise paying off high-interest debt first (e.g., credit cards). Consider debt consolidation or negotiating lower interest rates with creditors. Avoid taking on new debt unless absolutely necessary.
- **Increase Income:** Explore opportunities to boost your income, such as taking on a side job, freelancing, or selling unused items. Additional income can accelerate debt repayment and savings.
- **Seek Professional Advice:** Consult a certified financial planner or credit counsellor for personalised guidance. They can help you create a debt repayment plan, negotiate with creditors, and develop a sustainable financial strategy.
- **Adopt Frugal Habits:** Practice mindful spending by distinguishing between needs and wants. Cook at home, use public transport, and avoid impulse purchases. Small lifestyle changes can lead to significant savings over time.

- END OF QUESTION ANSWERS-